

CHAPTER-2

BELIEFS AND WORSHIPS

Introduction

Beliefs: The word '*Īmaniyat*' is derived from the word '*Īman*', which means to affirm, believe, trust, be subordinate and submissive. Here '*Īmaniyat*' means the beliefs and ideas that a Muslim must believe in; they are also called '*Zaroriyat e Deen* (the necessities of religion)'. In the teachings of Islam, it is mandatory to believe in the followings:

In the oneness of Allah, in all His Angels, in all His Books, in all His Prophets, in the Day of Judgment, in '*Taqdir*' (decree) and the Day of Resurrection.

A person cannot be called a 'believer' unless he sincerely believes in all the above-said beliefs and confesses to believing in them. He cannot be called a 'believer' if he does not believe in or deny any of them.

Worships: it mean; to express humility and submission to Allah Almighty and to live according to His commands.

Worship also includes performing the fundamental principles of Islam correctly, following the commands of Allah Almighty in social and economic matters and establishing national and international relations according to His guidance.

Objectives

The main objectives of this chapter are to inculcate in the students' minds the concept of the Hereafter and a sense of responsibility for their deeds. Further, they may be aware of the importance of fasting and Hajj - the two most important worships in Islam. Students may build their personalities by living their worldly life according to the will of Allah Almighty.

(A)-Beliefs

1-Belief in the Hereafter and its role in Personality development

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Know and explain the concept of the Hereafter.
- Understand the importance of the concept of the Hereafter.
- Explain the positive effects of the belief in the Hereafter on character building.

The Meaning of Belief in the Hereafter:

The word 'Aqeeda' stands for a firm belief in something. The word 'Aakhirat' means the life that is to come after. Thus, belief in the Hereafter means to have a firm belief in the life that is to come after this worldly life.

The belief in the Hereafter is one of the fundamental beliefs of Islam. According to Islamic teachings, one day, Allah Almighty will end this whole world with all its creatures. Then, he will resurrect it (i.e., to make the dead alive again). All the dead will be resurrected from their graves, and they all will come together before Allah Almighty.

The complete records of deeds that people have done in their worldly lives will be brought to the Justice court of Allah Almighty. Then, each person's deeds, whether good or bad, will be weighed. The one whose good deeds weight will be more than his evil deeds, he will be forgiven, and whose evil deeds will be heavier than good deeds, he will be punished. Those who are forgiven will go to Paradise, a place of innumerable eternal blessings. Man will get there whatever he desires. Those who are punished will go to Hell, a place of different severe torments.

The importance of the Belief in the Hereafter:

The importance of the belief in the Hereafter can be understood from the fact that likewise the Last The Holy Prophet ﷺ, all the Prophets taught this belief to their nations (Ummah). This belief had been the fundamental belief in every era. One of the qualities of guided and successful people is mentioned in the Holy Qur'an that such people believe in the Hereafter. Allah Almighty states in the Holy Qur'an:

وَبِالْآخِرَةِ هُمْ يُوقِنُونَ

Translation: 'And they believe in the Hereafter'. (Al Baqarah: 4)

Allah Almighty warns the believers of the horror of this in these words:

Translation: 'And fear the day in which you will be returned to Allah; and every soul will be paid back in full what it had earned, and they will not be wronged'.

Presenting the outlook of accountability of this day, Allah Almighty said:

Translation: 'So whoever does a good deed equal to the weight of the minutest particle, will see it. And whoever does an evil deed equal to the weight of the minutest particle, will see it'. (Al Zilzal: 7-8)

Role of the belief in the Hereafter in character building

Belief in the hereafter plays a vital role in building a responsible human character. This belief has a significant impact on human life. Some of them are as follows:

1. **Love of good and hatred of evil:** When a Muslim has faith that his every deed is preserved and will be rewarded accordingly on the Day of Qiyaama, he begins to love doing good and hate doing evil. Thus, he becomes a righteous person in society.
2. **Bravery and Courage:** The fear of perishing forever makes a person coward, but when a believer has this faith that life is not only perishable here, but the life of this world is temporary, and the life of the Hereafter is eternal, and Man does not perish by sacrificing his life for the sake of truth but achieves the everlasting life, so he gets ready to give sacrifice his life for the sake of truth. This creates courage and bravery in his heart.
3. **Patience and tolerance:** This belief creates a spirit of patience and tolerance in humans. A believer firmly believes that tolerating hardships for truth will be rewarded in the Hereafter. The Holy Qur'an states:

إِنَّمَا يَنفَعِي الصَّابِرُونَ أَجْرُهُمْ بِغَيْرِ حِسَابٍ

Translation: 'The patients will be paid their full reward, without an account'. (Al-Zumar: 10)

4. **Generosity and kindness:** A firm belief in the Hereafter also makes humans generous and kind. Because a believer believes that whatever he spends in the way of Allah Almighty, he will be rewarded the best in return in the Hereafter. It is stated in the Holy Qur'an: **Translation:** 'And whatever good you send ahead for yourselves, you will find it with Allah'. (Al-Baqarah: 110)

That is why the generous person is ready to spend for the poor in society and the collective well-being of the society.

5. **Sense of responsibility:** Belief in Hereafter develops a sense of responsibility in a person. Because he believes that performing the duty will be rewarded in Hereafter and failing to perform the duty will have accountability in the Hereafter. The Holy Prophet said: 'Every one of you

is responsible and will be asked about his responsibilities.' That is why the believer tries to perform his duties with a sense of accountability.

Summary of the Lesson

The belief in the Hereafter is one of the fundamental beliefs of Islam. According to this belief, this whole world will end one day. Then it will be resurrected again. All the dead men will be resurrected from their graves, and all deeds will be weighed. Those whose good deeds' weight will be more than their evil deeds, they will be forgiven and enter paradise, and those whose evil deeds will be heavier than good deeds will go to hell.

Belief in the hereafter plays a vital role in building a responsible human character. This belief creates the attributes of a love of good and hatred of evil, bravery, patience, generosity and kindness and makes a person fully responsible.

Activity for the Students

Students should explain to each other the meaning of belief in the Hereafter.

Narrate to the teacher one of the verses given in the lesson about belief in the Hereafter with translation.

Find two verses from the Holy Qur'an about the belief in the Hereafter and show them to the teacher.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. What is the literal meaning of 'Aqeeda'?/ What does the word 'Aqeeda' literally mean?
2. What is meant by belief in the Hereafter?
3. Write the translation of any verse related to belief in the Hereafter.
4. What impact does belief in the Hereafter have on personality development? State any one of them.

2. Fill in the blanks:

1. Allah Almighty will end this whole world with all its _____.
2. The full records of _____ will be brought to the Justice court of Allah Almighty.
3. The believer of the Hereafter has faith that performing the duty will be rewarded in _____.
4. Belief in the Hereafter makes _____ fully responsible person.

3. Tick ✓ on the right answer:

1. The belief in Hereafter was taught by:

- (A) Only The Holy Prophet ﷺ (B) Only Prophet Ibrahim عليه السلام
(C) Only Prophet Esa عليه السلام (D) All of the Prophets عليهم السلام

2. Their deeds, whether good or bad, will be weighed:

- (A) Only of infidels (B) Only of Muslims
(C) Only of hypocrites (D) Of all the human beings

3. Belief in the Hereafter creates in humans the sense of:

- (A) Being high (B) Being low
(C) Being responsible (D) Being successful

4. To believe in the Hereafter is the Quality of:

- (A) Only intelligent (B) Only scholars
(C) Only infidels (D) Guided and successful people

4. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. The belief in the Hereafter is one of the fundamental beliefs of Islam.	☐	☐
2. Hell is a place of innumerable blessings.	☐	☐
3. The life of the Hereafter is eternal.	☐	☐
4. Everyone will be asked about his responsibilities.	☐	☐

5. Choose the correct words to make the right sentence:

- The word 'Aqeeda' literally means to have firm (belief/doubt) in something.
- Those who will be forgiven will go to (Paradise/hell).
- The faith that he will be (rewarded/punished) according to his deeds on the Day of Qiyaama, he begins to (love/hate) doing good.
- The belief in the Hereafter makes humans (generous/miser).
- The belief in the Hereafter creates in humans a spirit of (patience/anger).

Instructions for the Teachers

To clarify the concept of the Hereafter in students and their character building, narrate some events from the life of Hazrat Abu Zar Ghiffari to students in such a way, that the belief in the Hereafter becomes a part of their lives.

Ask students to write a detailed essay on the following topics:

- The meaning of Qiyaamah.
- The concept of life after death.
- On what actions does the eternal success depend?

Belief in the Hereafter causes these things: love of worship, abiding by the roles and regulations, eradication of disappointment, patience and determination and freedom from the love of the world.

(B)-Worships

1-Fasting

Significance and social impacts

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Understand and explain the concept of fasting.
- Write the significance of fasting.
- Describe the social impacts of fasting.

Meaning of fasting:

The word 'Saum' or 'Siyaam' is used for 'fasting' in the Arabic language, which literally means to abstain from doing something. In Islamic Shariah, 'Fasting' means to abstain from eating, drinking and marital relationship from true dawn (*Subh e Saqid*) until sunset with the intention of gaining the pleasure of Allah Almighty.

Significance of Fasting

Fasting is one of the pillars and an important worship in Islam. It was made obligatory in 2nd A.H. It is obligatory on every *A'qil* (sane) and *Baligh* (mature/one who has reached the age of puberty) Muslim, man and woman to observe fasting in the month of Ramzan. Fasting is an obligatory worship like Prayer and Zakat for not only the Ummah of the Holy Prophet ﷺ, but it was also obligatory on all the previous nations of the Prophets. Allah Almighty says in the Holy Qur'an:

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا كُتِبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الصِّيَامُ كَمَا كُتِبَ عَلَى الَّذِينَ مِن قَبْلِكُمْ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَتَّقُونَ

Translation: O Believers! Fasting is made obligatory for you, like it was obligatory for those before you, so that you may attain piety.

[Al Baqarah: 183]

Only the sick, travellers and disabled persons are exempted from fasting with the condition that as soon as the illness, the journey or the disability is over, they will have to observe the missed fasts.

Our Holy The Holy Prophet ﷺ explaining the significance of fasting, said: 'Whoever observes fasts in the month of Ramzan with the intention of gaining faith and reward, his past sins will be forgiven.'



Fasting creates the realization of Allah's sovereignty and humbleness in man. While fasting, a person realizes that he cannot eat and drink without the will of Allah Almighty. Fasting develops the qualities of piety and self-control in man.

Social impacts of fasting:

Although fasting is an individual act, just like offering prayer with the congregation, it becomes a collective act during Ramzan. Thus, it does not only benefit Muslims individually, but it also has great effects on society. Some of them are as follows:

An environment of piety and purity:

In Ramzan, since every Muslim observes fast, an environment of goodness is established, in which goodness grows, and evilness is controlled.

Feelings of sympathy and grief:

Since almost every rich and poor person fasts in the month of Ramzan, enduring hunger and thirst, it creates a feeling of sympathy and grief for the poor in the hearts of the rich. As the Holy Prophet ﷺ said: 'The month of Ramadan is a month of sympathy and grief.'

A practical manifestation of human equality:

Fasting strengthens the concept of equality very much. In this month, rich and poor, ruler and subordinate, ordinary and special, almost all Muslims live in the same state of fasting. The sovereignty of Allah Almighty and their subjugation reflect clearly on the faces of all. This situation creates a sense of equality among them, which helps in eradicating the notion of high and low among them.

It is clear from the facts mentioned above that fasting is for our own benefit. There is no benefit to Allah Almighty in keeping us hungry and thirsty. He has made fasting obligatory for our good only.

Summary of the Lesson

'Saum' (Fasting) means to abstain.

Fasting means to abstain from eating, drinking and sexual intimacy with the intention of gaining the pleasure of Allah Almighty from true dawn (*Subh e Saqid*) until sunset.

Fasting is one of the pillars and an essential worship in Islam, which has importance and significance.

Fasting develops a feeling of sympathy and grief for the poor in the hearts of the rich.

Fasting creates a sense of equality and unity.

Activity for the Students

Students should explain the meaning of fasting and its significance to each other.

Write a verse and a tradition (Hadith) with translations about the significance of fasting and show them to the teacher.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. What word is used in Arabic for fasting?
2. What is meant by fasting?
3. In which year of Hijrah was fasting made obligatory?
4. On whom is fasting obligatory?

2. Fill in the blanks.

1. O Believers! Fasting is made obligatory for you, like it was obligatory for those before you, so that you may attain _____.
2. Fasting is obligatory on every *Aqil* (sane) and _____ Muslim, man and woman.
3. The Holy Prophet ﷺ said: 'The month of Ramadan is a month of _____ and grief'.
4. Fasting was made obligatory in _____ A.H.
5. Fasting creates the qualities of piety and _____ in man.

3. Tick ✓ on the right answer:

1. It was made obligatory in 2nd A.H:

- | | |
|------------|-------------|
| (A) Prayer | (B) Fasting |
| (C) Zakat | (D) Hajj |

2. Fasting is obligatory upon:

- | | |
|-----------------|---|
| (A) Every human | (B) Man |
| (C) Woman | (D) Every <i>Aqil</i> and <i>Baligh</i> man and woman |

3. Fasting is observed in the month of:

- | | |
|--------------|--------------|
| (A) Muharram | (B) Sha'baan |
| (C) Ramzan | (D) Safar |

4. They are allowed not to observe fast:

- | | |
|---------------|------------------------|
| (A) Labourers | (B) Employees |
| (C) Women | (D) Sick and travelers |

4. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. Fasting is one of the pillars of Islam.	☐	☐
2. Fasting is obligatory on insane.	☐	☐
3. Fasting strengthens the concept of equality.	☐	☐
4. Fasting was made obligatory in the month of Rajab.	☐	☐
5. Fasting creates the realization of Allah's sovereignty and humbleness in man.	☐	☐

5. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

1. The word (Saum/Sabr) is used for fasting in Arabic.
2. Fasting was made obligatory in (2nd A.H/9th A.H).
3. According to a tradition, observing fasts in the month of Ramzan, causes (past/future) sins be forgiven.
4. Fasting is observed from (true dawn/sunrise).
5. Fasting creates the qualities of piety and (self-control/freedom) in man.

Instructions for the Teachers

Arrange a debate on the significance of Fasting in the classroom among students.

Arrange a writing competition on the social effects of Fasting among students.

Make students write in detail on the following topics:

- The purpose of the obligation of Fasting.
- The importance of piety through Fasting.
- Effects of fasting on physical health.
- Laws of Fasting (Masaa'il-e-Roza)
- Social impacts of fasting (piety, sympathy, equality, generosity, unity).

2-Hajj and its globalization

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Understand and explain the concept of Hajj.
- Understand and explain the importance and significance of Hajj.
- Understand and explain the rituals of Hajj.
- Understand the globalization of Hajj (global benefits) and explain them.



Meaning of Hajj:

The literal meaning of Hajj is 'intention'. In Islamic Shari'ah, Hajj means 'to perform at a specific time *Tawaf* round the Ka'ba in Makkah and to perform certain deeds in other holy places'.

Importance and significance of Hajj:

Hajj is one of Islam's fundamental principles and an important act of worship. Hajj was made obligatory in 9th A.H. Once in a lifetime, it is the duty of every sane adult Muslim man and woman who can reach the House of Allah to perform Hajj. The Holy Qur'an states:

وَلِلّٰهِ عَلَى النَّاسِ حِجُّ الْبَيْتِ مَنِ اسْتَطَاعَ اِلَيْهِ سَبِيْلًا

Translation: 'And performing the Hajj (pilgrimage) of this house, for the sake of Allah, is a duty upon mankind, for those who can reach it.'
[Aal- Imran: 97]

The Holy Prophet ﷺ said: 'The Hajj is obligatory once in lifetime, and it is optional (Nafl) to perform it more than that.'

The Holy Prophet ﷺ warns those who do not perform the Hajj despite their ability and said: 'Whoever is not prevented from performing the Hajj by an obvious need or an unjust ruler or a severe illness, dies without performing the Hajj, it does not matter if he died as a Jew or a Christian.'

The Hajj is a Comprehensive Worship:

Hajj is an act of worship that comprises many acts of worship. Prayers and fasting are physical acts of worship, and Zakat is a financial act of worship, but the rituals of the Hajj are performed like prayer and fasting, and physical hardships of travelling are also borne. Further, money is also spent like Zakat.

A Muslim shows humbleness in prayer before Allah Almighty. Likewise, a Haji (pilgrim) shows his humility before Allah Almighty by leaving his fine clothes and having two sheets of *Ihram*, uttering all the time:

لَبَّيْكَ اللَّهُمَّ لَبَّيْكَ

Translation: 'I am present O Allah! I am present!'

and is engaged in doing Dua and request.

Rituals of the Hajj:

During the Hajj season, Muslims travel to Makkah from all over the world. When they reach the *Miqat* (the place to wear *ihram*), the men take off their national and cultural clothing and cover themselves with two white sheets, while the women in their clothes intend for Hajj and recite the prayer, called '*Talbiyah*':

لَبَّيْكَ اللَّهُمَّ لَبَّيْكَ، لَبَّيْكَ لَا شَرِيكَ لَكَ لَبَّيْكَ، إِنَّ الْحَمْدَ وَالنِّعْمَةَ لَكَ وَالْمُلْكُ لَا شَرِيكَ لَكَ

Translation: I am present O Allah, I am present, You have no partner with you, I am present; indeed all praise and all blessings and all the kingdom is for You, You have no partner with You'.

Pilgrims arrive at Mina in the morning of the 8th of Dhul-Hijjah and gather at Arafat ground in the morning of the 9th of Dhul-Hijjah, where they listen to the afternoon sermon. Here they offer Zuhr and Asr prayers together. After sunset, they leave Arafat ground and gather at *Muzda'lifah*. They stay there at night and offer Maghrib and Isha prayers together. In the morning of the 10th of Dhul-Hijjah, they throw stones at *Jamra Aqaba* (Satan), then offer sacrifices and shorten the hair or shave.

Then they go to visit Ka'ba, and after performing *Tawaf e Ziyarat*, they perform Sa'ee between Safa and Marwah hills.

After Sa'ee, they spend the three days of *Tash'reeq* in Mina, they perform shortened prayer (Qas'r) in the congregation, and after the declination of the sun (*Zawal*), they throw seven stones on all three *Jamrat* (Satan). After that, they come to Makkah from Mina, perform farewell Tawaf, and return to their countries.

Globalization of Hajj:

Just as the five times daily prayers gather the Muslims of the area in the mosque and the weekly Friday prayer gathers the Muslims of the city in the mosque, and the annual Eid gatherings gather the Muslims in the big cities of the country so that there may develop brotherhood, unity and harmony among them. Similarly, Hajj is also a global annual gathering in which Muslims from all over the world come together. Their colours are different, their languages are different, their races are different, and their countries are different, but they forget all their distinctions and present the scene of the one community in the one dress of *Ihram* and demonstrate global brotherhood and unity. In the same way, Hajj presents a picture of the global brotherhood and unity of the Muslims that is not seen in any other form of worship. Hajj presents a global form of human equality and erases all distinctions.

Hajj also gives global opportunities to Muslims to benefit from each other's knowledge and paves the way for global commercial gain. In this way, many countries gain commercial benefits.

Summary of the Lesson

The literal meaning of Hajj is 'intention'. In Islamic Shari'ah, Hajj means to perform at a specific time *Tawaf* round the Ka'ba in Makkah and to perform in other holy places certain deeds. Hajj is an important act of worship in Islam. It is obligatory once in a lifetime on every Muslim who is able to reach the House of Allah. Moreover, Hajj is a source of global brotherhood and unity among the Muslims of the world.

We learned from this lesson that Hajj is a global act of worship, which is an essential source of mutual brotherhood and unity among the Muslims of the world. It presents the scene of global human equality. It introduces people of the world to multiple civilizations, languages and cultures. It provides opportunities to gain benefits from international trade. The spiritual benefits are other than these.

Activity for the Students

Students should narrate the meaning and concept of Hajj and its globalization to one another.

Write a short article on the importance of Hajj and show it to the teacher.

Collect the pictures of the rituals of Hajj and make a beautiful album.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. What is the literal meaning of 'Hajj'?
2. What is meant by 'Hajj' in Islamic Shariah?
3. Upon whom is Hajj obligatory?
4. What does 'Miqat' stand for?

2. Fill in the blanks.

1. Hajj was made obligatory in _____ A.H.
2. The *Tawaf* of _____ is performed in Hajj.
3. The stones are thrown at Jamrat in _____.
4. At _____ Maghrib and Isha prayers are offered together.
5. Hajj is obligatory _____ in a lifetime.

3. Tick ✓ on the right answer:

1. A global annual gathering takes place in:

- | | |
|------------|-------------|
| (A) Prayer | (B) Fasting |
| (C) Zakat | (D) Hajj |

2. Hajj is obligatory on:

- | | |
|------------------|------------------------------|
| (A) Every human | (B) Young muslims |
| (C) Muslim women | (D) Everyone, who is capable |

3. Hajj is obligatory in a lifetime:

- | | |
|------------|---------------|
| (A) Once | (B) Twice |
| (C) Thrice | (D) Very year |

4. Zuhr and Asr prayers are offered together behind the Imam of Hajj at:

- | | |
|---------------|-----------------|
| (A) Mina | (B) Arafat |
| (C) Muzdalifa | (D) Holy Makkah |

4. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. Hajj is a global act of worship.	☐	☐
2. Hajj is only a financial act of worship.	☐	☐
3. Hajj is a source of mutual brotherhood among Muslims and the source of global human equality.	☐	☐
4. Hajj does not teach Muslims to sacrifice their everything in the way of Allah.	☐	☐
5. Hajj provides to gain benefits from international trade.	☐	☐

5. Define the following words in brief:

1. *Miqaat*_____.
2. *Ihram*_____.
3. *Tawaf*_____.
4. *Talbiyah*_____.

6. Choose the correct words to make the right sentence:

1. The literal meaning of Hajj is (intention/grooming).
2. Hajj is (obligatory/optional) once in a lifetime.
3. It is stated in a tradition that whoever is capable and does perform Hajj, it does not matter if he dies as a (Christian/Jew).
4. Hajj is a source of mutual (unity/difference) among the Muslims of the world.

Instructions for the Teachers

Explain the summary of the rituals of Hajj to the students.

Ask students to write briefly on the following topics:

- What is meant by Hajj?
- Define Miqaat, Ihram, Talbiyah, Umra, Baitullah, Station of Ib'rahim, Safa, Marwah, Mina, Arfat, Muzdalifah, Ramiul Jimar, sacrifice,
- Hajj and international relations.